Ministero della Salute

# HPAI outbreaks in Italy

PAFF Committee – Animal health and welfare

19-20 February 2026

# HPAI H5N1 in Italy

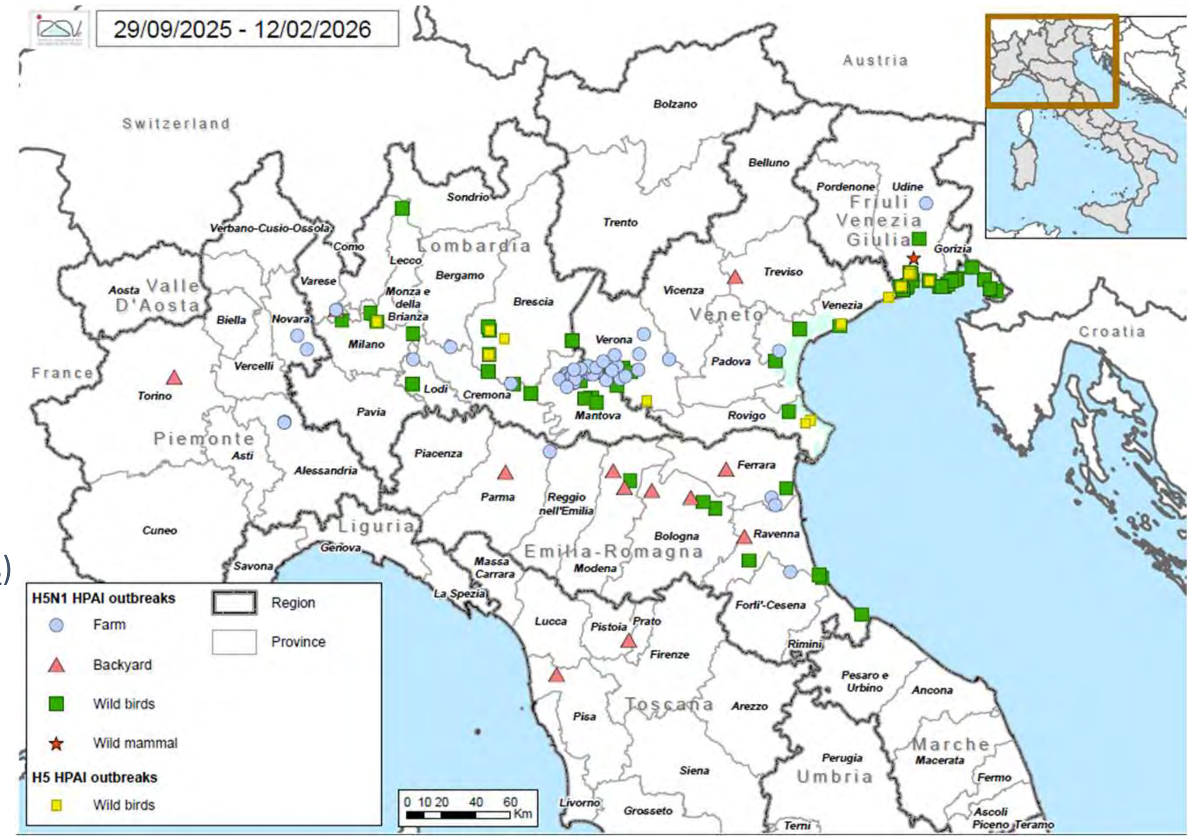
*updated 12/02/2026 – last case of HPAI was confirmed on 7th February 2026*

✓ **63** HPAI outbreaks in poultry (commercial and backyard)

- **26** Lombardia (+2)
- **18** Veneto (+8)
- **11** Emilia – Romagna (+1)
- **5** Piemonte
- **2** Toscana (+1)
- **1** Friuli – Venezia Giulia

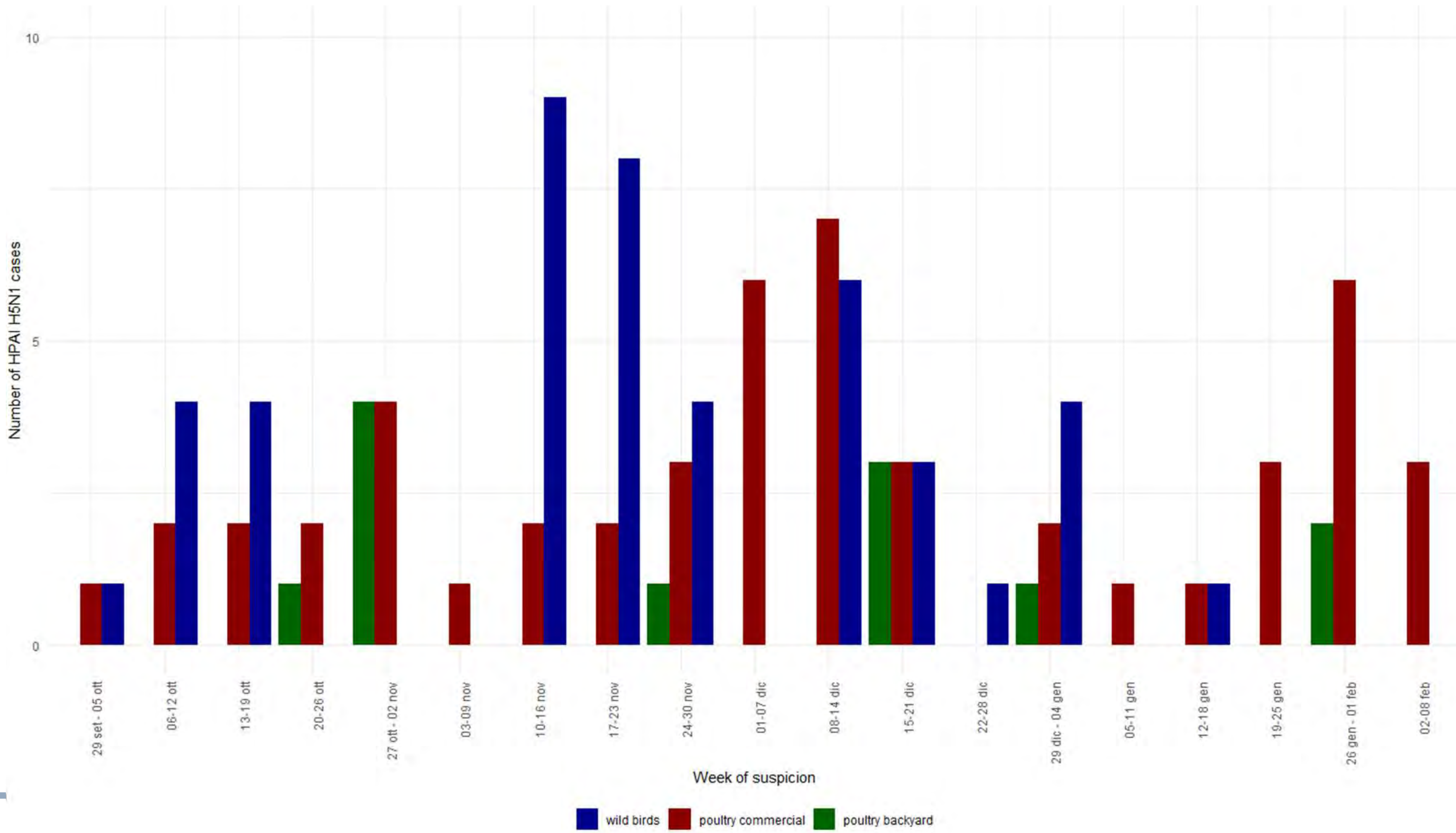
✓ **100** HPAI positive cases in wild birds (*177 infected subjects*)

- **47** Friuli – Venezia Giulia (+5)
- **27** Lombardia (+1)
- **18** Veneto (+2)
- **8** Emilia – Romagna (+1)




Regular update on: https://www.izsvenezie.com/reference-laboratories/avian-influenza-newcastle-disease/italy-update/
https://eurlaidata.izsvenezie.it/

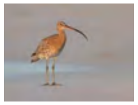
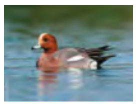
# HPAI H5N1 epidemic curve

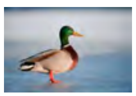
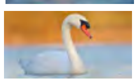


# HPAI H5N1 in poultry

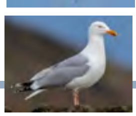
- a worsening of the epidemiological situation: seven new outbreaks have been confirmed in the last week of January in the provinces of Verona and Mantua

| Region | Meat turkey | Broiler | Laying hen | Multispecies | Chicken breeder | Phaesant | Duck | Capon | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Emilia-Romagna | 3 | 2 | 1 | 5 | | | | | **11** |
| Friuli-Venezia Giulia | | 1 | | | | | | | **1** |
| Lombardia | 14 | | 8 | 1 | | 1 | 1 | 1 | **26** |
| Piemonte | | | 1 | 2 | 2 | | | | **5** |
| Toscana | | | | 2 | | | | | **2** |
| Veneto | 15 | | 2 | 1 | | | | | **18** |
| **Total** | **32** | **3** | **12** | **11** | **2** | **1** | **1** | **1** | **63** |



# HPAI H5N1 in wild birds

- The first cases detected 3 weeks later than in 2024, majority belonging to *Anseriformes* Order, followed by *Charadriiformes*, *Accipitriformes* and *Phoenicopteriformes*

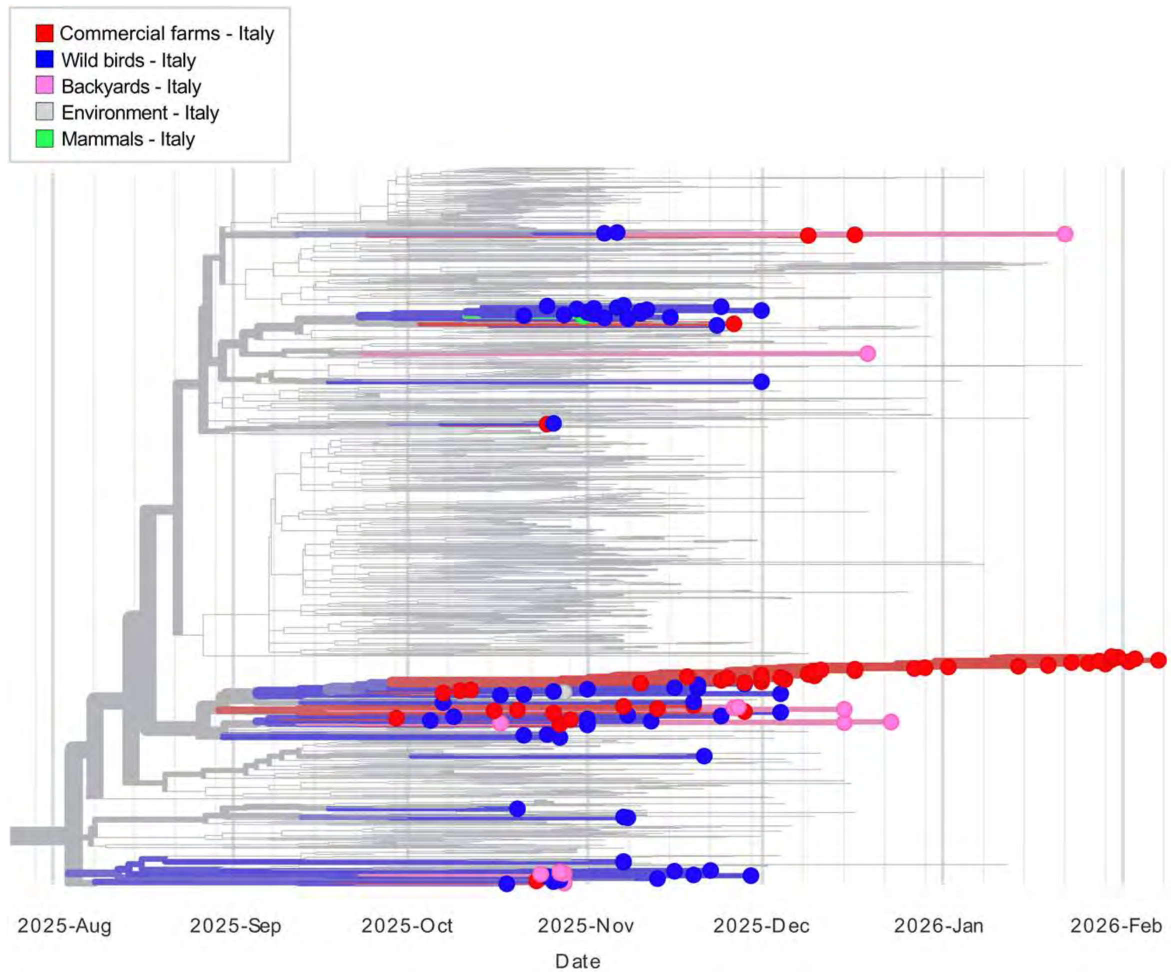
- Positive cases were **mainly** found through active surveillance (hunted=93 and trapped=13), followed by passive surveillance (moribound or found dead=71)

| *SPECIES* | EMILIA-ROMAGNA | FRIULI-VENEZIA GIULIA | LOMBARDIA | VENETO | Total |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***Common Buzzard*** | 1 | | 1 | 1 | **3** |
| ***Common Teal*** | 1 | 7 | 13 | 18 | **39** |
| ***Eurasian Curlew*** | | 1 | | | **1** |
| ***Eurasian Wigeon*** | | 51 | 1 | | **52** |
| ***Flamingo*** | | 1 | | | **1** |
| ***Gadwall*** | | 1 | | | **1** |
| ***Greylag Goose*** | 4 | 2 | 2 | | **8** |
| ***Herring Gull*** | | 1 | | | **1** |
| ***Mallard Duck*** | 4 | | 6 | 6 | **16** |
| ***Muscovy Duck*** | 1 | | 3 | | **4** |
| ***Mute Swan*** | | 28 | 15 | 1 | **44** |
| ***Northern Shoveler*** | | | | 1 | **1** |
| ***Western Marsh Harrier*** | | | | 1 | **1** |
| ***Whooper Swan*** | | | 1 | | **1** |
| ***Yellow Legged Gull*** | 3 | | | 1 | **4** |
| **Total** | **14** | **92** | **42** | **29** | **177** |

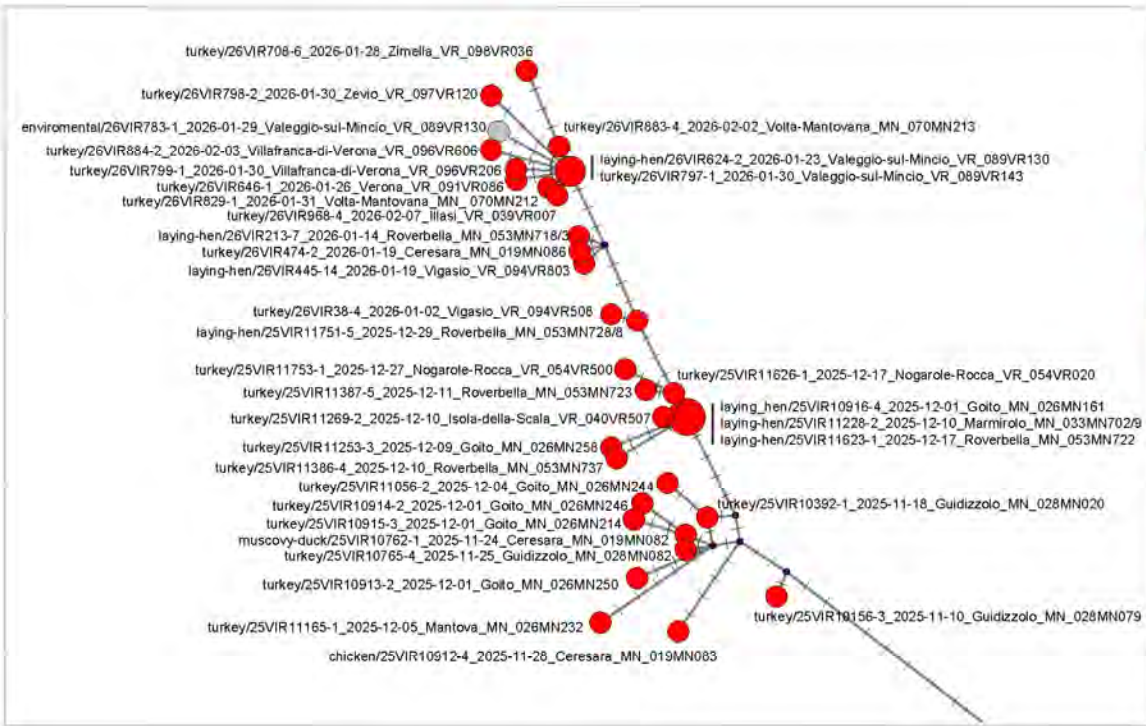
# Overview of the genomic characteristics of the H5N1 viruses collected in Italy during the 2025-2026 wave

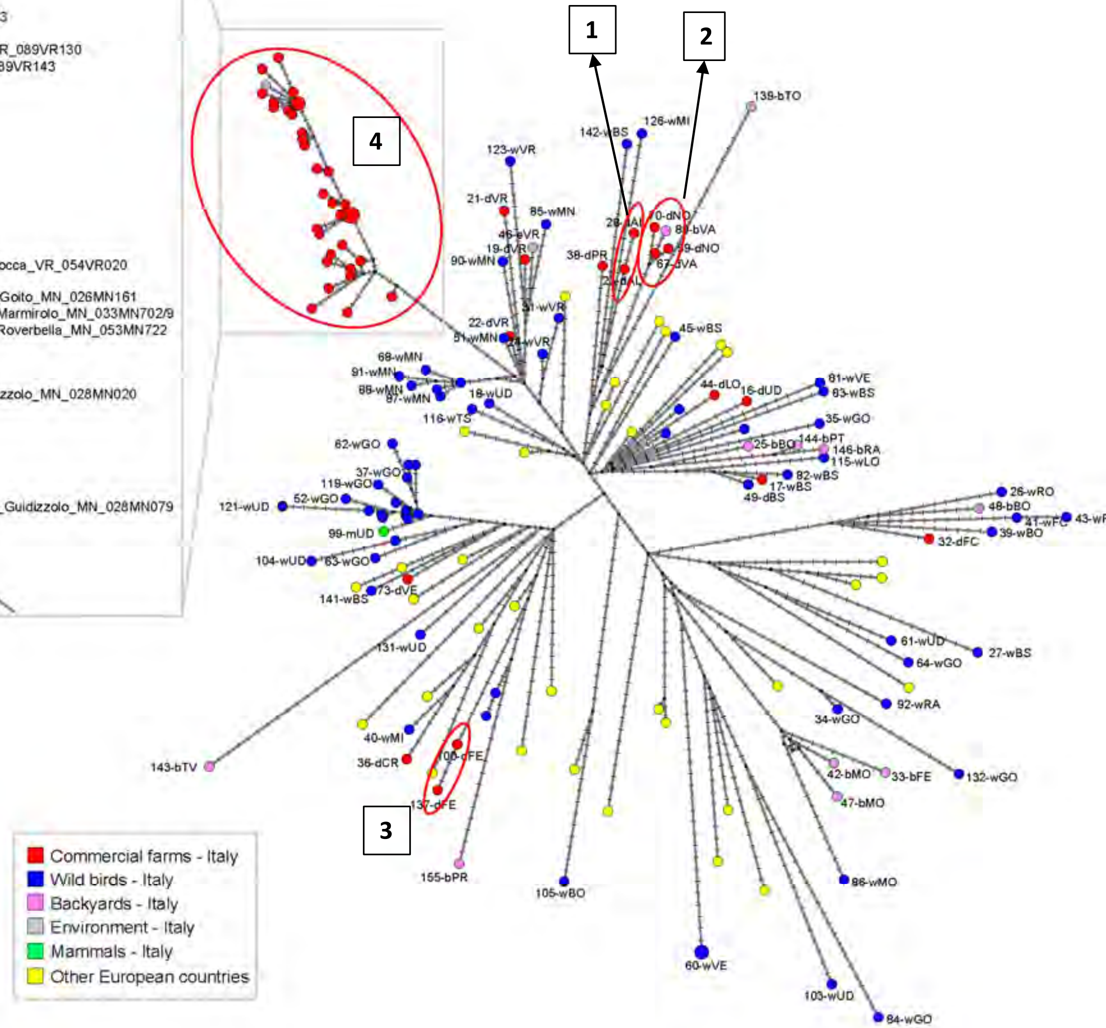
All HPAI H5N1 viruses identified and analyzed in Italy since September 29, 2025, belong to a new subcluster of the EA-2024-DI.2 genotype, designated **EA-2024-DI.2.1.**

Time scaled phylogenetic tree of the complete genome shows multiple introductions of HPAI H5N1 viruses in Italy.



# Genetic Network with the H5N1 viruses collected in Italy during the 2025-2026 wave



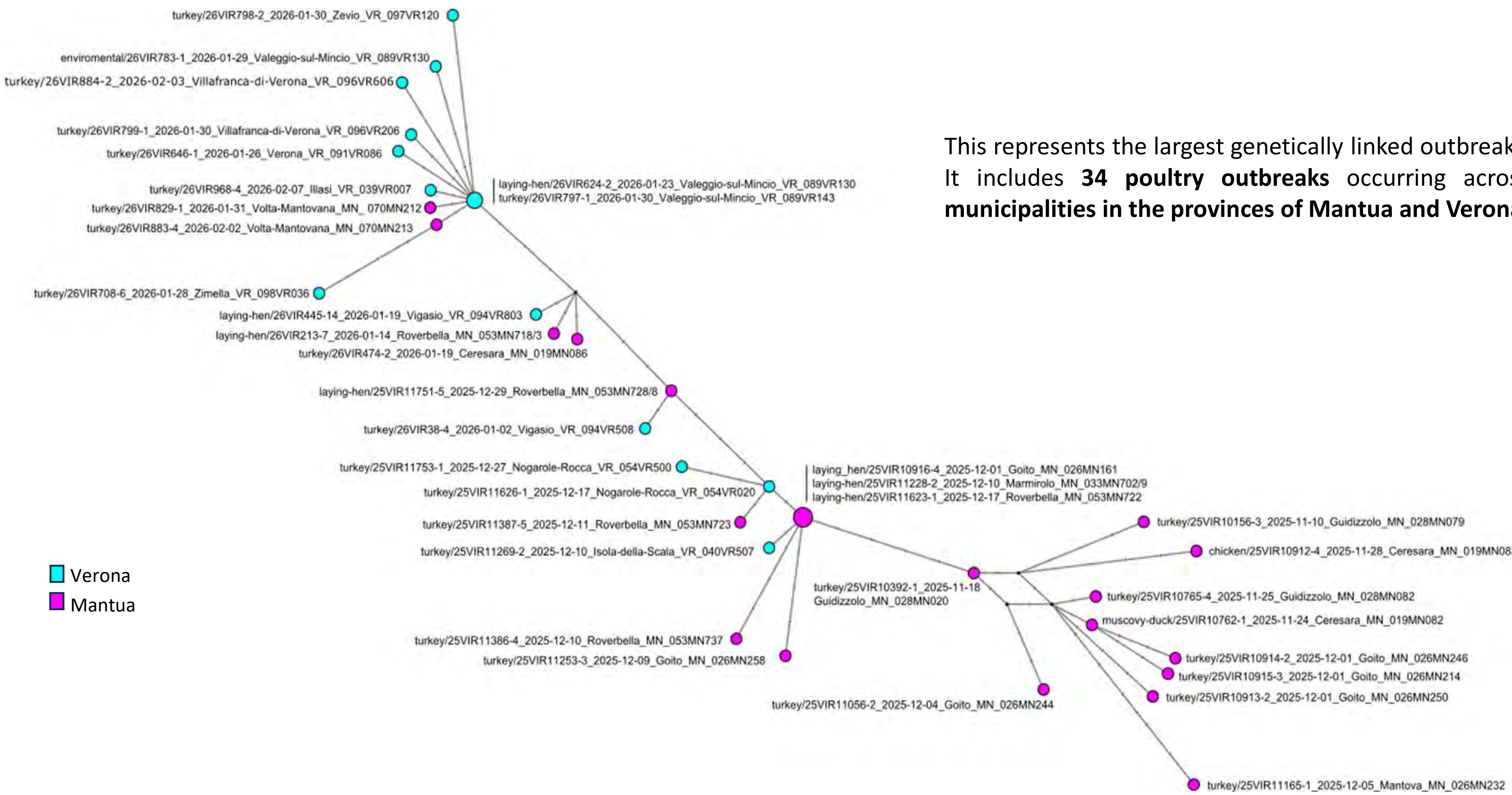




Genetic analysis indicates the occurrence of multiple primary introductions from wild into domestic birds.

**Four genetically linked clusters**, highlighted by red circles, have been identified in

1. Alessandria Province (16-20 Oct 2025)
2. Novara-Varese Provinces (7-19 Nov 2025)
3. Ferrara Province (9-17 Dec 2025)
4. Mantua-Verona Provinces (10 Nov 2025 – 07 Feb 2026)

## Genetic Network – Genotype EA-2024-DI.2.1 –
## Focus on Mantua-Verona cluster (10 Nov 2025 – 07 Feb 2026)




This represents the largest genetically linked outbreak cluster.
It includes **34 poultry outbreaks** occurring across **16 different municipalities in the provinces of Mantua and Verona.**

# HPAI Epidemiological Situation & Key Findings

**Worsening epidemiological situation**

•Seven new HPAI outbreaks confirmed (late January) in Verona and Mantua

•Central Crisis Unit (CCU) convened on February 2

**Role of active surveillance**

•Early detection in turkey farms without clinical signs or increased mortality

**Virological evidence**

•Viruses show close genetic relatedness

•No definitive conclusions on transmission dynamics

**Transmission assessment**

•No evidence of human-mediated secondary spread

•Possible role of under-surveilled wild bird species under consideration

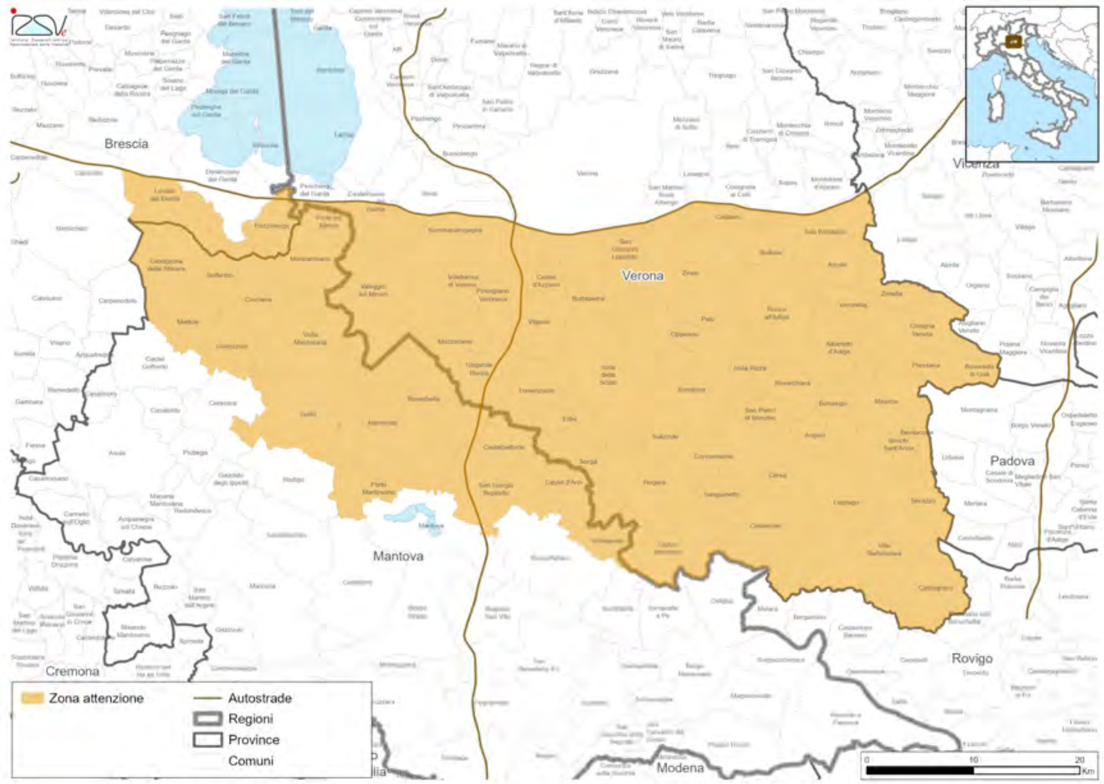
**Identified risk factor**

•Inconsistent/ineffective biosecurity measures may have facilitated spread

# Control Strategy & Measures Implemented

Ministerial Note No. 3757-06/02/2026-DGSA-MDS-P

**CCU strategic priorities**
•Intensified surveillance in a wider area
•Weekly monitoring of turkeys and laying hens
•Decongestion of high-density turkey farming areas
•Strengthened biosecurity enforcement
**Strategic decisions**
•Focus on enhanced surveillance until end of February
•Longer-term FRZ not considered proportionate
**Measures adopted (Attention Zone)**
•Establishment of Attention Zone with **weekly monitoring**
•Preventive culling near recent outbreaks
•Encouragement of early slaughter in higher-risk farms
•Strengthened official veterinary controls (biosecurity & culling oversight)
•Continued surveillance in surrounding areas (**every 15 days**)



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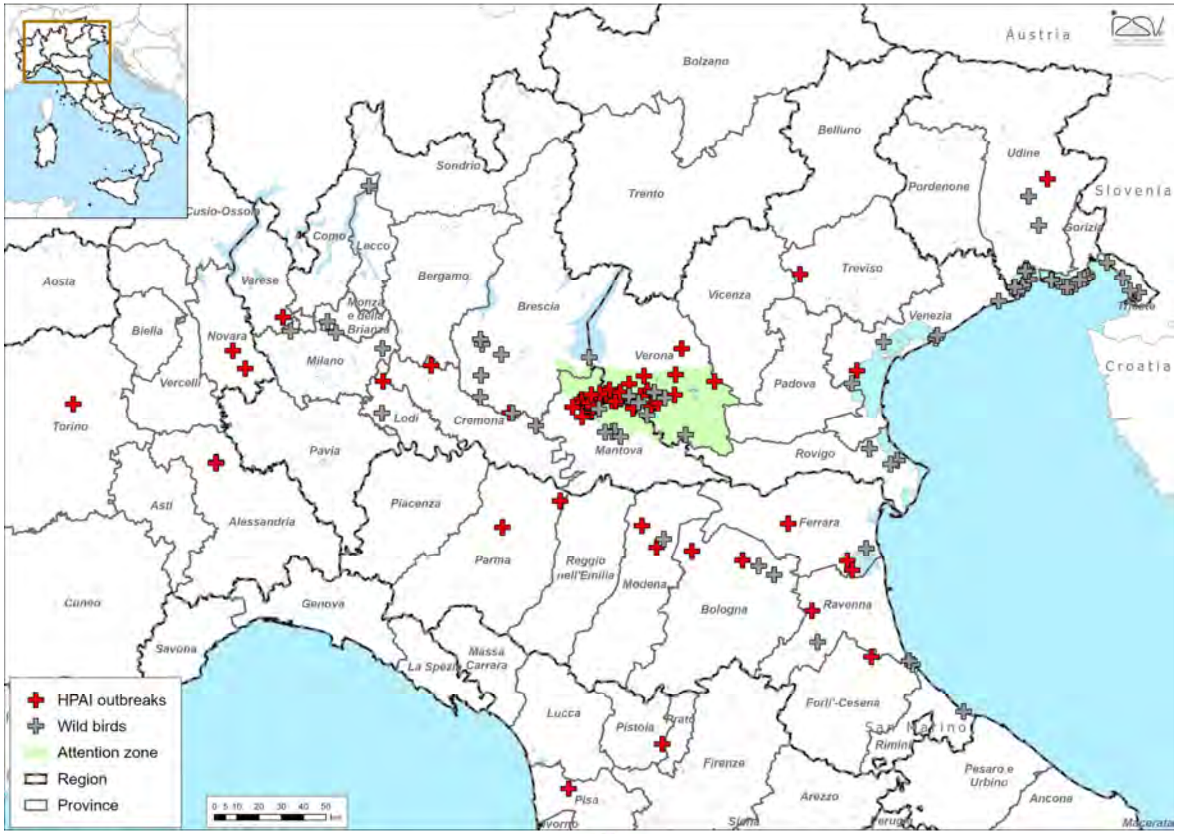

Thank you